

OUTER EVENTS REFLECT SELF-CREATION -- THREE STAGES

My dearest friends, I greet you, I bless you, and I welcome you this evening. The time is ripe to give this specific lecture because a sufficient number of my friends on the path will be capable not only of intellectual understanding but also of putting some of its principles into practical use. As always, I do have to repeat certain facets in order to make the connections clear and make the topic one comprehensive whole.

The human mind is squeezed into a narrow box, as it were. It is in a box of misperception and limited perception. Only as you know yourself do you gradually gain a proper perspective and perception of life and its relation to your inner self-creation. The perception of the human mind is specifically faulty in that you take what you see as the whole. Yet you only see small segments. This then alters the nature of the perceived aspects of reality. It sheds a totally different picture on life, on creation, and on the processes of life and creation. Imagine as an analogy that here is a vast picture, but you only glimpse a small aspect of it through a narrow opening because the rest of the picture is covered. What you see then is only a part of reality, but if you believe it is the whole, your entire perception and understanding are faulty. It is the same way with the human mind and the human perception in regard to the real world.

At the same time, this human mind is capable of infinite expansion and of transcending its present limitation. The specific limitation of the mind must and will eventually be transcended in order to realize its total scope. A lot of human misperception stems from a very one-sided focusing and conditioning. The mind conditions its own beliefs, perceptions, observations, and perpetuates them as long as these self-conditioning processes are not being challenged or questioned. But as long as they are being taken for granted as the truth, the mind remains in a box. So, in order to gain a deeper understanding and a clearer picture of reality, you must first know that you brainwash yourself continuously.

This occurs particularly in relation to your experiences in life. As long as the connection between inner reality, inner conditions, inner landscape, and outer experience is as tenuous as it is now in most human beings, the nature of life and the relationships between life and self are totally distorted. The box the mind finds itself in becomes painfully narrow and limited. All perceptions are untrustworthy because the main perception of life and self are off center.

The illusion that outer life imposes experience on you is so widespread that the brainwashing is very difficult to stop. In this lecture, I would like specifically to discuss three basic stages in growth and development seen from the point of view of your life experience.

The stage that is farthest removed from reality, broadly speaking, would be when all events seem totally disconnected from you. The world seems, as I have often said, a fixed place in which

your personal experiences come to you as a result of pure chance, hazard, luck, or misfortune. But in the curve of growing there occurs a progression. You begin to distinguish events that you have created, perhaps not consciously, deliberately, but nevertheless you know you have caused the results you now experience. However, you still cannot see this when it comes to "outer" events which seem to have nothing to do with you. When events of such a nature affect your state of happiness and peace, then you are still very much removed from your center. The outer event then becomes removed and only symbolically reflects your inner state or aspects of your inner self you are supposed to deal with but have refused to pay attention to until now. This refusal and self-imposed blindness again and again removes you from the point of self-creation to such an extent that the results of your creation not only seem, but actually are, removed from you and appear disconnected from your volitions processes.

This is a very painful state because what happens to you appears "undeserved," and life becomes very frightening in its apparently unpredictable character. You truly seem to be a victim of circumstances beyond your own sphere of influence. This causes a great deal of fear and distrust in life. It also perpetuates the greatest human hoax: man is a victim. No "game" is deadlier and more painful. Yet no resistance is greater than the one to give up this hoax, to take the blinders off and see beyond this so very limited vision.

Of course I have discussed this principle many times in different contexts. My friends involved in the pathwork, after much overcoming of resistances and blocks in themselves, actually begin here and there to experience that what seemed absolutely and incontrovertibly a fixed outer event into which they haphazardly were put or which came to them, is really a very logical extension of their own inner attitude and explicit intentionality. It reflects specific distorted ideas which then "require" specific and distorted action, reaction, and volition. When this bridge is established, an entirely different world view comes into being. Slowly, little by little, the false focus straightens itself out, and the vision of life moves into a clearer perspective.

As you know, connecting of inner attitudes requires courage, humility, and honesty. It demands the utter integrity of self-responsibility. But the relief, the safety, the new energy and creative strength that accrue cannot be measured in mere words. Many of you are moving continuously in this direction. And as you go on, the resistance to make these connections diminishes. The stake you have in maintaining the fiction of being a victim of life diminishes by the ratio in which your self-responsibility increases and becomes so pleasurable that you would not exchange it any more for the untruth of victimization.

The more you enter this new state, the less will events occur so far removed from you that they can only be symbolically interpreted -- and then incontrovertibly recognized -- as your creation. The more often you establish these connections and thus see your own hand in shaping your life experiences, the less will events occur that are so far removed from you that you can only draw the connecting link by using the event as a symbolic outpicturing of an aspect of your inner landscape. This brings you to the second stage in this progression.

In the second stage you can relatively easily see the outer event as a result of your attitudes. This does not mean that you can immediately cease these particular creations, for you need to gather a great deal of self-understanding and need to expose and release much pent-up energy and stagnant feelings before you begin to recreate your life. However, experience is now mostly obviously a

result of your attitudes, intentions, beliefs, and feelings. You can see how this or that experience is a specific result of commensurate desires, defense mechanisms, destructive actions, clinging to negative behavior patterns, etc. Needless to say that in this stage it is impossible to feel quite so helpless, anxious, afraid, victimized, and hopeless. Even if the personality still doubts, at this point, his own capacity to change these specific attitudes and patterns because a still deeper level of negative intentionality (not wanting to change them) has not been uncovered, at least the world no longer appears such a chaotic place. This represents a great step forward on the evolutionary scale.

In the third stage in this progression, your attitudes and actions, your intentions and feelings have become sufficiently purified, realistic, and productive that you now create mostly positive life experience. Outer events fall more and more into place. As I discussed in the last lecture, you are moving into a new self-generative process of positive creation and experience. But you are not yet completely purified. Your mind is now much more aware of its own pitfalls and is thus capable of quickly penetrating the veil of illusion. But clouds still remain. Thus you occasionally suffer from your own moods, from fluctuations of moods which sometimes seem to come and go without any outer "reason." Here you can no longer deceive yourself that someone or something else is doing it to you. You know it is your mood. Of course, sometimes you may say that your dark mood is a result of so and so having done this or that to you. And this may well be true. But then such an occasion does not belong in the third category. It belongs in either one or two, depending on your vision of it. Stage three means that you know your mood is not caused by any outside factor, but simply occurs in you without outer provocation or reason. It is as though a cloud has come over the sun, and you do not yet know why, but you do know it is in you. Yet you are still a victim to the fluctuations of your own moods. This third stage is least removed, but it is still removed. By this I mean that the manifestation moves steadily closer into you as a result of your having established the links in the previous stages.

What causes those inner clouds suddenly covering up the inner sun may vary, of course. It may be that you repress a certain feeling, a certain perception in those around you because you are unwilling to deal with the pain or the frustration involved. Or you may simply experience the inner movement of your path which inexorably reveals deeper material for you to deal with as you go on. Those moods are then signposts for you, enabling you to pay attention to something in you that could otherwise never become known to your conscious mind.

In this context, once again, when I speak of inner reality, I do not merely refer to a psychological or emotional state. The inner reality is the wide, vast universe, and you, as a personality, stand on the borderline between this wide, vast, endless, infinite inner "space" of creation in which every conceivable state of consciousness, expression, and condition exists. On the other side exists the outer void that has to be "filled" with consciousness and light, with love and life. The material body is the boundary, the border state. The consciousness behind the body is the carrying agent whose task it is to bring inner reality into a void. The only problem is that in this border state it is often forgotten that the inner reality is the real world, or even that there is such a world.

Now, in the darkness of the limited mind, it is almost impossible to conceive of an actual world existing within or through you, leading to infinite "spaces." You can conceive of space only in terms of the outer, reflected reality. Only the space of the three-dimensional state of consciousness appears "real." Yet, even your physicists know today that the relationship of time/space/movement

knows infinite variety, that the time/space/movement continuum of your world (i.e., your state of consciousness) is relative and only one of many possibilities and not a fixed, exclusive "reality" applicable to all states.

When a human consciousness "dies," as it were, what actually happens is that it withdraws from its shell into another time/space/movement continuum, which is the inner world.

Just as time, space, and the relationship of movement within this specific space-reality are results of a specific state of consciousness, so are landscapes, objects, conditions, natural laws, the atmosphere, the climate, and relative reality also results of specific states of consciousness. Your inner world is thus a total product of your overall state of consciousness. In this inner world you connect with others whose overall state of consciousness approximates your own so that you share a commonly created sphere of temporary reality. The same applies of course to this earth sphere, with the only difference being that the inner states are externalized in a way that is often more difficult to discern.

You also know that your consciousness is not just one unified state. You consist of many aspects of consciousness which may often be in total disagreement among themselves and whose state of development may vary very much.

When the real self takes on a task before it goes into an embodiment, it chooses to take certain aspects "along" with it, if I may put it this way. On the path you are helped to fulfill this task to bring unification between these disconnected aspects of your consciousness; to refine; to re-educate; to purify these divergent aspects -- a task the real self has undertaken to fulfill. Your active, determining outer consciousness, or your ego, if you will, can choose to seek the connecting understanding or to evade it. This ego consciousness is the borderline between the inner light world and the outer void. As I said, when the mind becomes involved in the partial reality of three-dimensional consciousness, it can easily forget the task, and it requires struggle to reawaken consciousness. I might also add here that man receives a great deal of spiritual guidance and help, if only he wants to perceive it.

When the mind forgets and is disconnected from the truth of being, the conscious ego self, at times, temporarily identifies with the aspects to be re-educated and purified so that it then loses a sense of its real identity. This is always an extremely painful state but happens only when pride, self-will, and fear are allowed to rule the consciousness. The moment the aspects one had exclusively identified with and therefore struggled against seeing are exposed, owned up to, and realistically evaluated; this shameful isolation ceases and the aspects are seen exactly for what they are -- simply aspects of the total self.

It is therefore extremely important in your pathwork that you explore yourself and stop hiding, concealing the negative part of yourself. For the more you hide it, the more you lose yourself in it, and the greater the desperation of the illusion becomes. Only when you take the courage and adopt the humility to again and again and again acknowledge and expose the negative parts of yourself, does the miracle occur. You then no longer identify (secretly) with the parts that you wish to hide. Paradoxically as this may seem at first glance, the more you expose the destructive part, the more you know of your true creative self. The more you expose the ugliness, the more you

know your beauty. The more you expose the hatred and all its derivatives, the more you know of your already existing state of love that can then shine through.

Just imagine, my friends, the incredibly painful predicament you put yourself in when you hide that which you are most ashamed and afraid of. It is precisely because of this hiding that you compound the very attitudes you most hate in yourself. You make them infinitely worse through the concealment and then become more and more convinced on deep levels of your consciousness that this is your real being. That is the vicious circle that makes you more determined to hide and therefore more isolated, more negative and destructive due to the methods of hiding (hiding always requires projecting your real guilt on others, blaming, self-whitewashing, hypocrisy, etc.). Therefore you become more convinced that this hidden part is the ultimate you for which there is no hope. The true task must begin by exposing all of you. I have said it so many times, there just is no way around this aspect of spiritual development. All the seekers of spiritual growth who avoid this delude themselves and must at one time or other encounter a rude and painful awakening. You must go through it. You must expose it all. And that brings in its wake that the worst opinion of yourself is never justified, no matter how ugly the traits and attitudes may be that you have hidden. They are never justified because these parts are only isolated aspects of the total consciousness your real self has taken charge of.

As you go through these steps, you become aware of your higher self, not as a theory or philosophical premise but as a stark reality right here and now. You experience yourself as the real entity you are, you have always been, and will always be, no matter what the isolated aspects of consciousness fabricate in delusion and folly. This is indeed a great wonderful task! In the process of it, you learn of your inner reality and all its various aspects and levels of consciousness. You see the outer event in perspective to the inner landscape. The inner landscape is then no longer some symbolism or a colorful analogy. It is indeed stark reality.

Now let us return to the three basic stages in this specific respect. As you work along the precepts of this path and establish the connections between you and the events, no matter how remote from your volition and your responsibility they may seem, a curious reversal begins to take place in your vision of self and life. What first seemed cause (outer event) now becomes effect and vice versa. What first seemed merely symbolic analogy (the inner landscape) is now stark reality, while the outer events become symbolic representations of the inner reality. This new perception brings about a whole gamut of new reactions to life. A deep inner sense of security arises because now thoughts and desires, feelings and attitudes are seen as the creative agents. Thus thoughts, opinions, beliefs, feelings, attitudes are no longer irresponsibly handled on the delusion that they do not count and are of no consequence. This new awareness brings with it a sense of your being a creator in the scheme of things.

If you do not resist to go beyond the faulty, limited logic of materialistic consciousness in which life appears a given, fixed thing into which you are put, you will experience the cohesion between the outer event and the inner life. The peace, joy, security, sense of oneness with all of life that are the inevitable result make the past resistance against this state seem utterly ludicrous. Yet, you human beings struggle against this more than against anything else. You seek all sorts of explanations. Various ages have created different answers so as to explain away the results of your inner creation, so as to not take responsibility, to not relate outer events with your own inner state. You have such a stake in not doing this, yet nothing could be as liberating as this new approach to

yourself and your life. Nothing else can give you the true tools to create your life in a new way, to recreate it. For when you have seen your negative creation, you have the tools to institute positive creation in which the same principles prevail. You have conditioned yourself to gloss over the negative thoughts and interpretations you harbor, to ignore seeing the deliberately built up stake you have in seeking justification for your faults, for your spite and malice. You would rather do anything than see that you deliberately choose unhappy experience for nefarious reasons. You produce and create, often on a vast scale, painful, debilitating, frustrating experience. And then you use this fact as a justification to become more bitter, resentful, punishing, withholding the best you are and have within. You lose track of the volitional element of these creations, and the suffering becomes very real. The more you lose the connection with self-creation, the more bitter and hopeless the suffering becomes. Then you pretend to yourself that your thoughts and your intent have nothing to do with your experience. You try to convince yourself that they can have no real power. But eventually you begin to see that they do have power.

Often the creative power for thought, intent, emotional attitudes is ignored because of time interval. The childish mind sees effects of causes only in an immediate, obviously apparent, close together unit. Only the more mature mind can discern an effect removed from a causal agent. When negative intentionality exists, the mind remains proportionately childish, and blind, and perceptions are commensurately limited.

Once you have reached the second stage in which you begin to recognize experiences as products of your attitudes, soon you will have more and more experiences where this is easy to detect and fewer and fewer experiences that are a total outer projection and symbolization of inner reality. You may still be stuck here or there and find yourself consciously resisting positive creation. But this affords you the opportunity to focus your efforts, your attention, your energies on becoming conscious of further buried material that causes this blockage. Now, at least, you know where you are stuck and why. You can choose and direct your focus in a meaningful way. You can reverse the course of what is now a meaningful sequential chain: thought and created intent and action (or the lack of it).

I advise all my friends to specifically commit themselves more and more to seeing their lives in these terms. What is lacking and how do you create it? How much are you willing to be in truth with yourself? All the way? That is the great question.

Take now the third state, your moods. You all have been in situations when suddenly without reason a mood has changed from sunny to rainy. This may at first appear more frustrating than when you can pin this fluctuation on some outer reason. At the same time, it leads you more directly toward your nucleus. You can no longer blame it on others and thus escape from your truth. As long as other people can be used as scapegoats for your bleak moods, you are much farther away from the truth than when nothing untoward has happened, and yet your mood has changed. It is so frustrating that you start rebelling and objecting inside of you. This occurs to the extent you still have a stake in blaming others for your state. You struggle against the flow of your inner movement. The childish part in you declares that nothing pleasant should ever change. If you feel good, now it should be final. The demand of and belief in the finality of the present (favorable) mood also creates the other side of the coin -- when you are in a difficult, depressed, bleak mood, you despair because then again you must think this mood, too, is final. You do not allow yourself to connect with the inner movement of the flow. If you learn to tune in, to listen into, and to follow

the inner life stream in a very focused and attentive way with your finest inner perceptions, you cannot fail to perceive that there is a constant inner movement.

The analogy is often used, in dreams as well as in other symbolic language, that man's sojourn in the human body is a journey. This analogy has often been made throughout spiritual history. It reveals a profound truth: the inner path is in constant movement through the stages of soul matter that have to be traversed. This journey is indeed not just a word. It is a constant flowing movement. And so is your own personal path. It is a movement. It carries you through your landscape. It carries you through the landscape of your higher self, which is beautiful and brilliant. But if the task you have come to fulfill is left behind, you will not experience this beautiful landscape too often because then you stay in the landscapes of those other aspects of your consciousness which you have come to unite and integrate with the real self.

What happens when you withdraw after a lifetime into the inner universe with these various aspects? You live in them alternately. The aspects you have not succeeded to make one with the higher self remain separated fragments in their own self-created worlds. You must occasionally reside in these separate worlds, the amount of "time" (for lack of a better word) depending on the intensity of each state. Each will indeed be a world like, for example, this material world but with different conditions, dimensions, laws which will, while your mind is fixed on them, appear like the only reality just as this sphere seems the only reality while you are exclusively focused on it. All these worlds are worlds of consciousness and action. Since you have many different aspects, you will reside in many different worlds. But only in the highest world of your developed consciousness will you know that the other worlds are not your ultimate worlds, not the only worlds. While your consciousness is focused in any of these other worlds, you forget your real identity, just as while you are a human being, you do not know your real identity while you identify with the less developed aspects of your being. Then, indeed, the sojourn in the lower worlds of those aspects seems final for as long as it lasts. This finality is an illusion, and only when you are in the greater reality of your light world do you know that the only final reality is beauty, love, truth, light, and bliss. All other states are temporary.

Now when your mood clouds over and you fall into despair and you struggle against the mood, you do not follow the inner movement, and you believe you are in the only final world of darkness. I say to you, my friends, the mere fact that you consider these thoughts of truth -- without struggle and panic, without fearful ideas of finality -- will make you aware that there is a movement taking place. This will make an enormous difference, for it will lead you to explore and find out what the movement into the cold means for you. Instead of struggling against the darkness, accept it as a temporary state and move with it. By fighting it, you stop the movement. By accepting it, you follow the movement. It will then carry you through. If you accept the pain and consciously connect with its meaning, it ceases to be pain. And so it is with the bleak or dark or negative mood. See it as a cloud and follow the movement that carries you, with the aim to comprehend its meaning. Each cloud is a meaning. Commit yourself to comprehend the meaning of the mood. And your inner path will reveal the answer.

I have advised you again and again, as a tool of the pathwork, to use what I call a daily review. Go through the days in terms of the various moods that "overtook" you during this specific day. Now I say "overtook" in quotation marks because it is again an illusion. It is as if you looked through the wrong end of a telescope. You produce it, but you do not know it. It is a movement in

you, it is an aspect in you. It is your landscape. The mood expresses a specific meaning, and it is up to you to allow your inner self to produce the answer, to bring these various moods into the pathwork activity and follow through these patterns at various times and phases. If you observe them, you will derive a tremendous meaning from them. Your disconnectedness from the meaning of the mood makes it appear as if it "overtook" you in a similar way as the outer event appears to you independently from anything you have produced. As long as you do not know and do not want to know that part in you which is compatible with the mood that created it, that attracted it, that is an energy field which inevitably drew this outer event to you and you to it, you will feel disconnected from it.

Now, perhaps, in this lecture in which I attempt to bridge the gap between psychological reality and spiritual reality, it will become possible for you to use spiritual reality as a practical guideline. You all know that, as a rule, psychological reality stops short at the self-creating aspect of your inner being and your life. And it ignores the self-responsibility of you in all things. And you also know that, as a rule, spiritual reality in the way it is mostly spoken about on earth does not provide you with the psychological means to make practical use of the creative truth. Spiritual activity then becomes an escape from psychological factors. But it is equally true that the way psychology proceeds today, it, too, becomes an escape from man's deepest self-responsibility and thus robs him of his capacity to create and recreate. I attempt to unify the two as two facets of the same truth. By leaving out one facet, the other becomes in its own way an escape and an incomplete approach to man's struggle on earth.

Before terminating this lecture, I would like to speak here about a historical progression in terms of self-responsibility. In ancient times, man experienced himself completely dependent on gods. In centuries not so far removed from your own, a religious counter-movement had taken over in which the human being's failings, his poverty, illness, insanity were chalked up against him. He was ostracized as a sinner, as an outcast. He was judged. This was a distortion of the reality that everyone indeed creates his own state and experiences. However, if such a reality is misused in a separative, loveless, judgmental spirit, the truth becomes a dangerous half-truth. It has to be temporarily left behind so that a new and better balance can come about. Thus the past century now behind you, whose spirit is still prevalent now, negated the concept of self-responsibility. In broader terms of evolution, this is a counter-balance of the previous distortion and half-truth. The present tendency is that the suffering person is seen as an innocent victim. Self-responsibility is confused with the previous blaming, arrogant, punitive attitude. Thus man is weakened and misled about his own potentialities. Psychology ignores the important factor of real guilt that must be recognized for what it is behind every so-called neurotic and unjustified guilt.

Only now, in the evolutionary spiral movement of mankind as a whole, does man become capable of assuming responsibility without distorted blame. Now he can find the way to own up to his negativities without despairing because he can transcend his limited consciousness at this stage. His journey has taken him sufficiently far so that he has spiritually matured and is ready to find the balance, to find the love and the truth of creative self-responsibility. Now the truth of self-responsibility can be regained on a new level. Instead of using this truth against others so as to set up the little ego, it can be used on the self. The truth of self-responsibility can be practiced not as a punitive accusation but as the highest form of dignity of man. So only when you want to be in truth about your negativities and destructiveness can you find the grandeur of your creative self and know that you are a creator and a god, a "God-carrier," as it were. The pendulum must swing until

love and self-responsibility are no longer split into apparently mutually exclusive opposites but become one comprehensive whole.

My dearest friends, I bless all of you from the world of love, truth, and vital energy. Use this energy, as you so often do, to go deep into yourselves and become one with one another. Be in peace.

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